Jeffrey Benson

Northern Virginia | linkedin.com/in/jeffreytbenson/ | bensonjt.github.io/profile | github.com/BensonJT

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Brought in eight times to problems nobody owned, across eight unfamiliar domains in thirty-one years. Release management, ISO 9000 quality systems, capital and expense governance, IT asset management, privileged access security, field dispatch, fiber deployment, applied AI. The skill was never the subject matter; it was the discipline to decompose an unmapped process, quantify what it actually cost, and hand back an instrument the operators kept using, with the judgment to know where the number had to be exact and where close enough was the right answer. Lean Six Sigma Black Belt, now building software that accelerates the process modeling and automates the data analysis.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Process Excellence | Lean Six Sigma (DMAIC) | Operational Excellence | Process Architecture & Decomposition | Value Stream Analysis | Capacity & Demand Modeling | Business Case Development | Change Management (ADKAR) | Applied AI & Automation | Data Engineering (Python, SQL) | Data-Driven Decision Support | Root Cause Analysis | Executive Stakeholder Influence | Coaching & Mentoring

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Principal Consultant | Cornerstone Solutions | Lovettsville, VA

December 2025 – Present

Principal of an independent process excellence practice, encoding a thirty-year process methodology as software that renders six industry-standard process languages, IDEF0, SIPOC, BPMN and Value Stream Mapping among them, from a single captured process model. Modeled the first client engagement in that instrument before designing anything, and the resulting process model became the delivered system's architecture.

Every stakeholder wanted the process in their own notation, and most clients had no baseline to prove improvement.

- Cut process model build from roughly 8 spreadsheet hours to 2, then generated 6 industry-standard process languages from the one captured model instead of drawing each separately.
- Built a transformation metric that computes before-and-after impact from process structure alone, so clients with no measurement baseline still get a defensible business case.

Building real software without an engineering team made the hard part trusting the code, not writing it.

- Shipped 18+ sprints of a multi-tenant SaaS product solo on Python, FastAPI, React and TypeScript over row-level-secured PostgreSQL, directing an AI assistant against written specifications.
- Governed AI-generated code with 30 architecture decision records, a three-layer automated test suite and a human sign-off gate on every stage of an autonomous build loop.
- Built a structural validation engine spanning 6 process notations and a standards-faithful BPMN export that opens in Camunda with layout intact, proven by round trip on a live client model.

An AI assistant would hand over a confident, plausible optimization that made the system slower.

- Measured every optimization an AI agent proposed instead of accepting it, using DMAIC to find the two root causes that actually governed runtime and cut a nightly pipeline from 7 hours to 4.
- Built a self-healing ingestion pipeline pulling 12 market data sources into PostgreSQL, with gap-fill and reconciliation so the database repairs its own history instead of needing manual backfill.

Sr. Manager | Verizon | Ashburn, VA

Feb 2019 – Dec 2025

Served SVP-led organizations across Global Network & Technology as Business Transformation Partner and Black Belt, governing roughly 50 improvement initiatives to $455M at 128% of target while running DMAIC on the cross-organizational problems teams could not solve alone. Pivoted in 2023 to building the workforce capacity, forecasting and automation-foundation models that operating teams and finance ran on, and coached peers on the benefit modeling that made their initiatives countable.

Teams were improving things everywhere, but improvement nobody documented or priced counted toward nothing.

- Built and defended a custom benefit model for every initiative served, translating operational KPIs into minutes, hours and wage rates or into contract rates, underwriting $455M at 128% of target.

Automated dispatch kept getting worse the more business rules were added, because nobody governed the map underneath.

- Rebuilt the zip code universe from US Postal Service files cross-referenced against internal systems, finding the dispatch map covered only about 30,000 of 41,326 zips and could never serve the rest.
- Redesigned 41,326 zip codes into 521 contiguous work areas built around rivers, bridges and mountain passes, moving auto-dispatch from the 30-40% range to the 70-80% range nationally.

Capacity planning ran on averages, so Finance and Operations argued staffing from two different realities.

- Surfaced $18M to $22M in capacity variance and $3M to $4M in avoidable overtime with a Force-to-Load model built in house for $1.5M less than the alternative.
- Won approval for 50 additional technicians by pricing work in minutes with a modified PERT distribution instead of averages, showing leadership where the demand actually was.

Fiber builds ran many months and nobody could say where the time went, so every conversation was anecdotes.

- Measured a fiber backbone build end to end so a Black Belt work-out could target it, verifying a 35% cut in build interval and 39% in OM96 fiber installation year over year.

Generative AI arrived inside the company and most people had no idea what to do with it.

- Built and shared a library of Gemini assistants, including developer personas that debugged uploaded scripts against a defined framework, compressing the cycle from writing a function to deploying it.
- Waited for an approved enterprise AI platform before any company code touched a model, using advice-only prompting until it arrived, then adopted it deeply and brought the team along.

Manager | Verizon | Ashburn, VA

Jan 2013 – Jan 2019

Led large cross-organizational process excellence programs to remove friction at the seams between teams and deliver SVP-driven strategic objectives.

Application teams waited more than seventeen weeks for infrastructure, and nobody had ever mapped why.

- Decomposed the asset lifecycle into 400 activities across 64 systems, found 200 forms of TIMWOODS waste, and located the delay in 110 handoffs rather than in any individual step.
- Removed 43% of the critical path and a third of the 110 handoffs by redesigning around the seams between owners rather than around the tasks inside them.
- Cut asset acquisition from over 17 weeks to under three, an 82% reduction, and gave application teams a provisioning wait they could plan around.

Five years after the business case was approved, nobody had established whether it was ever delivered.

- Closed the DMAIC Control phase at the five-year mark, returning to the same asset data to surface $61M realized against a $40M target rather than reporting what had been projected.

Migrations turned into hours of circular troubleshooting in night change windows, and two administrators carried it.

- Closed the full DMAIC by end of Q2, then kept improving what it produced: weekly velocity 8x in Q3, 21x in Q4, 33x at year end and holding into 2018, on the same two administrators.

A new executive director mandated Scrum on the team that owned the asset database everything else resolved against.

- Coached the team that owned the ITAM database and the CMDB through a mandated agile adoption, running 10+ sprints and 500+ user stories and moving them from compliance to belief.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Founder, Lead Architect & Full-Stack Developer | Benson Academy | Lovettsville, VA

March 2026 – May 2026

Built and shipped a production web application and an AI-assisted content system as an unpaid personal project, designing a human-in-the-loop pipeline that grounds generation in a curated knowledge base and gates publication behind mandatory human review. Volunteer work, and the proving ground for the AI-assisted build model later used on paid client engagements.

AI could produce the volume, but content that cannot tolerate one unverified claim put speed against accuracy.

- Designed a human-in-the-loop content pipeline grounding generation in a curated knowledge base and gating every lesson behind mandatory human review before publication.
- Cut research-to-published cycle time roughly 80% with AI-assisted content workflows, using Lean analysis to standardize the lesson template so downstream assets generated reliably.

Multi-modal lessons needed a real application, built and deployed by one person with no team and no budget.

- Shipped a production Next.js and TypeScript application through an agentic development workflow, driving Claude Code and Gemini CLI to build an MDX system embedding components in lesson text.

EARLY CAREER EXPERIENCE

Senior Member of Technical Staff | Verizon | Silver Spring, MD

Served directors and executive directors as an individual contributor across release management, quality systems, and capital and expense governance, entering each domain unfamiliar and standardizing what had been improvised.

Demand ran to $3B against a $2.2B budget, and every intervention had to be tracked against both.

- Reengineered the FP&A cycle with DMAIC, cutting cycle time 70% and delivering output that would have taken 4.5 times the staff by hand, valued at $4.2M over more than six years.

An SVP mandated ISO 9000 across the organization and nobody in it knew the standard, including me.

- Implemented ISO 9000 and CMM Level 2 across 24x7 technical operations, cutting critical system outages 80% and procedural errors 86%.

Half the round-the-clock engineering team left every year, and nobody could say exactly why.

- Built the training framework and 143 standard operating procedures that took attrition in a 24x7 technical operations team from 50% to 1%.

Every release manager planned their own way in their own spreadsheet, and what got missed was learned the hard way.

- Tripled annual release throughput from 665 to over 2,000 with no added headcount, on a template design Verizon was still patterning after twenty years later.

EDUCATION

- Master of Arts (M.A.) in Organizational Management | University of Phoenix
- Bachelor of Arts (B.A.) in Computer Systems & Psychology | Grove City College

CERTIFICATIONS

- Master's Certificate - Project Management (PMBOK)
- Lean Six Sigma Black Belt | Professional Scrum Master (PSM I) | ITIL v3 Service Management

SECURITY ELIGIBILITY

- Inactive GSA Public Trust Suitability (est. 2021).
- Inactive Held DoD Secret Clearance (est. 1991-1993)